

Lenovo LOQ 15IRX10

The end of the budget gaming laptop?

For years, the definition of a "budget gaming laptop" was simple: you paid under ₹1 Lakh, you got a decent mid-range GPU, a plastic body, and you accepted compromises. It was the entry point. The "cheap and cheerful" option.

With the Lenovo LOQ 15IRX10, that definition is officially dead.

At ₹1,40,990, this machine commands a price tag that would have bought you a premium Legion or ROG Zephyrus just two years ago. Yet, it still wears the modest, plastic uniform of the entry-level LOQ series. This contradiction forces us to ask: Has the budget category disappeared, or has it simply evolved?

Packing the brand-new NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5060 (8GB GDDR7) and a desktop-class Intel Core i7-14700HX, Lenovo isn't selling you a "starter" laptop anymore. They are selling you flagship firepower in a utilitarian wrapper. I spent a week with this machine to find out if this new breed of "premium-performance, budget-build" laptop is the future of gaming.

Here is what I found.

DESIGN AND BUILD

If you've seen a Lenovo LOQ from 2023 or 2024, you've seen this one. It retains that signature industrial grey aesthetic – utilitarian, stealthy, and entirely plastic (polycarbonate).

While the chassis doesn't scream "premium" like an aluminum MacBook or a Legion 7, it feels reassuringly sturdy. There's minimal deck flex, and the hinge is solid, I could open it comfortably with one finger. It's not trying to win a beauty pageant; it's trying to survive your backpack. For a machine housing this much power, the weight is manageable at 2.4 kg, though you definitely won't forget it's there.

₹1,49,990



Port selection is practical for a gamer. You get 3x USB 3.0 ports, a USB Type-C port, HDMI, and a dedicated Ethernet port, which is increasingly rare but vital for stable ping. However, a significant omission at this price point is Thunderbolt support. Despite rocking an Intel chip, you don't get that lightning-fast connectivity for high-speed docks or external GPUs, which is a letdown for power users.

DISPLAY

Here is where things get complicated. The unit ships with a 15.6-inch FHD (1920x1080) 144Hz panel.

I have to be critical here: At ₹1,40,990, a 1080p screen is a tough pill to swallow. In this price bracket, I would typically expect a QHD (1440p) or even a 4K panel, especially given that competitors often offer higher pixel densities for clearer text and sharper textures. If

you are a content creator looking for 4K pixel-peeping precision, this omission might be a dealbreaker.

However, looking past the spec sheet, the actual experience is surprisingly competent. In my testing, the colors were punchy and vibrant, definitely not the washed-out 45% NTSC panels we used to see in budget gaming laptops. More importantly for competitive gamers, the motion clarity is excellent. Playing Valorant, I noticed zero ghosting or smearing, which is critical when you're pushing high frames.

Lenovo has clearly prioritized "Frames per Second" over "Pixels per Inch" here. It's a polarizing choice, but for a pure gaming machine, it might be the right one.

PERFORMANCE

This is the part where the price tag starts to make sense.

While the RTX 5060 is the headline act, the entire supporting cast – CPU, RAM, and Storage – is tuned for maximum throughput. This isn't just a gaming laptop; it's a portable workstation.

The Intel Core i7-14700HX is arguably the star of the show. With 20 cores (8 Performance, 12 Efficiency) and 28 threads, it is a massive leap over typical "H" series processors.

- **Cinebench R23:** The multi-core score of 25,275 is staggering. To put that in perspective, this chip rivals desktop CPUs from just a couple of years ago. It chewed through my rendering workloads without breaking a sweat.
- **Single-Core Speed:** A score of 2,062 in single-core performance ensures that snappy responsiveness in tasks and, crucially, high framerates in CPU-bound games like CS2.
- **Geekbench 6:** Scoring 17,474 in multi-core, this machine proves it can handle heavy multitasking. I had Premiere Pro rendering in the background while browsing with 20+

